LIS 470 Studio

Storyboarding and Paper Prototyping

goals

- practice storyboarding
- design a paper prototype for a task
- experience user testing and gather feedback for refining design ideas

storyboarding

- A sequence of sketches or images that shows a potential interaction with a design problem.
- **Purpose:** To show how the design meets a user need.
- **Key Elements:**

  Story arc: Rising action, climax, and falling action

  Sketches: Line, shape, people, annotations

  Camera angles: Wide shots, close-ups

Building a storyboard

1. **Draw your frames**. You likely want 5-7 frames to tell a compelling story
2. **Outline our story**. Where does it happen, what is the problem, how is it resolved?
3. **Annotate your frames.** Write the key points to your story below each frame

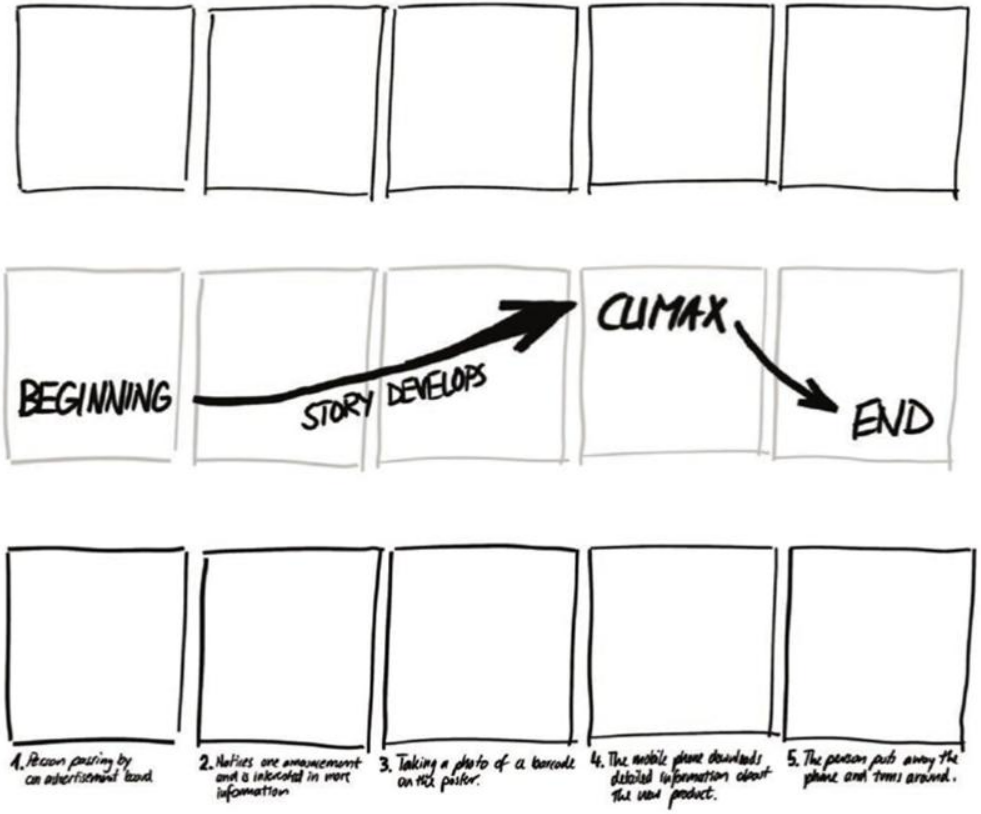

Image from Greenberg, *Sketching User Experiences*

Building a storyboard

4. **Sketch your frames**. Think about what *camera shots* will help you tell your story

5. **Emphasize action**. Add any annotations you need to emphasize the action.

Image from Greenberg, *Sketching User Experiences*

storyboarding activity (20min)

instructions:

- Select a recent problem you have encountered (not related to your class project)- can be as simple as ordering food, booking a cab, or poor navigation of a building
- Create a 4-7 panel storyboard showing that **problem** in sequence.
- Swap with a peer to create a “**solution storyboard**” that solves the problem creatively
- Create a storyboard that tells the same story, this time with a creative solution to the problem that leads to a different outcome.
- Share the solution storyboard and provide a critique (i.e., one thing they liked about the storyboard, and one thing they thought could be improved).

storyboarding tips!

remember:

- Show the story arc (beginning, middle, end).
- Use camera angles to highlight moments (wide shot vs. close-up).
- Annotate where necessary (e.g., emotions, actions, need, goals).

paper prototyping

- A quick, low-cost way to create interface mockups.
- Simulates the user interface using simple materials.
- Easy to iterate and test with users.
- Great for visualizing interface flow and user interaction.
- Paper prototyping involves creating a limited set of materials for the website
- Different materials and techniques can be used to create the different elements of an interface (e.g., paper, cardstock, sticky notes, pens)

paper-prototyping tips!

remember:

- **Keep it Simple:** Focus on a vertical slice (limited set of features).
- **Use Different Materials:** Use sticky notes for buttons, cardstock for pop-ups, etc.
- **Test and Adjust:** Encourage feedback from the test user.

paper prototyping activity (20min)

instructions:

- Select a simple website or app task that you perform on regular basis (e.g., ordering food, reserving a book, finding a social event).
- Create the screens required for that task. You should create a processing screen, and an under-construction screen.

  Examples: Start screen, processing/loading screen, error screen.

- You can use different materials (post-its, paper, markers) to differentiate elements like buttons, text fields, and images.
- Consider your screen flow and the task instructions you'll give to a tester, including prompts to guide users without leading them directly.

paper prototype testing (20min)

testing steps:

- Set up a **facilitator**, “**computer**,” and **user**.

  One student acts as the **facilitator** guiding the test. Another student acts as the **“computer”** controlling the paper prototype. The participant (from the other team) tries to complete the task.

  Everyone tests their prototype with a participant and switches roles so everyone experiences the process.

- Facilitators prompt participants if they’re stuck but avoid giving direct instructions.

de-brief

- Think about how storyboarding helped you communicate a problem and solution.
- Consider the constraints of paper prototyping and what it taught you about prioritizing essential elements- reflect on affordances, signifiers and user-friendly interactions
- Reflect on the testing feedback, what surprised you, and how would you improve? These insights are invaluable for your final design project!
- **Next steps:** Teamwork and **A7**